

C2 Reading

Academic diagnostic - Reading

Level	C2 - Proficiency Diagnostic
Skills assessed	Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Format	Academic entrance diagnostic test

Reading

Proficiency, judgement and the problem of excessive language

At the highest levels, language proficiency is rarely a matter of knowing more grammar in a simple quantitative sense. The learner's challenge becomes rhetorical: choosing how direct to be, deciding which implication can be left unstated, recognising when precision becomes pedantry, and when fluency begins to conceal vagueness. A speaker may produce complex sentences and still fail to sound intellectually controlled if every idea is overstated or every qualification is treated as a decorative flourish.

This is why advanced diagnostics should not merely ask whether a structure is correct. Correctness remains necessary, but it is no longer sufficient. The stronger question is whether the language is proportionate to the situation. A complaint to an institution, an academic response, a seminar intervention and a personal reflection may all require accurate grammar, yet they demand different degrees of compression, tact and explicitness. The advanced learner must therefore demonstrate not just range, but restraint.

Task design can distort this judgement. A simplistic prompt may reward speed while concealing weak interpretation; an excessively academic prompt may reward familiarity with a genre rather than genuine control. A responsible C2 diagnostic uses several lenses: dense reading, layered listening, extended writing, spontaneous speaking and grammar items that test judgement as well as form. It should ask not only whether an answer is correct, but whether it is purposeful, responsive to context and stylistically mature.

The best feedback at this level sounds less like a verdict and more like an editorial conversation. It notices when complexity becomes ornament, when caution becomes evasion, and when fluency loses precision. It does not punish ambition, but it asks the learner to choose. At C2, excellence is often the capacity to use less language more exactly.

01	What is the main claim about highest-level proficiency? A. It is mainly vocabulary quantity. B. It removes the need for accuracy. C. It depends on rhetorical judgement, not just more grammar.
02	When can fluency become a problem? A. When it is too slow. B. When it uses simple words. C. When it conceals vagueness.
03	Why is correctness insufficient? A. Correctness is irrelevant. B. Grammar cannot be assessed. C. Different contexts require different rhetorical choices.
04	What does proportionate language mean? A. The longest possible answer. B. Language without nuance. C. Language suited to situation and purpose.
05	What can a simplistic prompt conceal? A. Excellent handwriting. B. Fast reading only. C. Weak interpretation.

06	What risk does an excessively academic prompt create? A. It makes grammar impossible. B. It removes vocabulary. C. It may reward genre familiarity rather than control. _____
07	What should C2 grammar items test? A. Only spelling. B. Only speed. C. Judgement as well as form. _____
08	What does editorial conversation imply? A. A final punishment. B. A casual chat without standards. C. Precise developmental feedback. _____
09	What does complexity becomes ornament mean? A. All complex language is wrong. B. Ornament improves clarity. C. Complex language used decoratively rather than purposefully. _____
10	What is excellence at C2 often described as? A. Speaking as fast as possible. B. Avoiding all risk. C. Using less language more exactly. _____